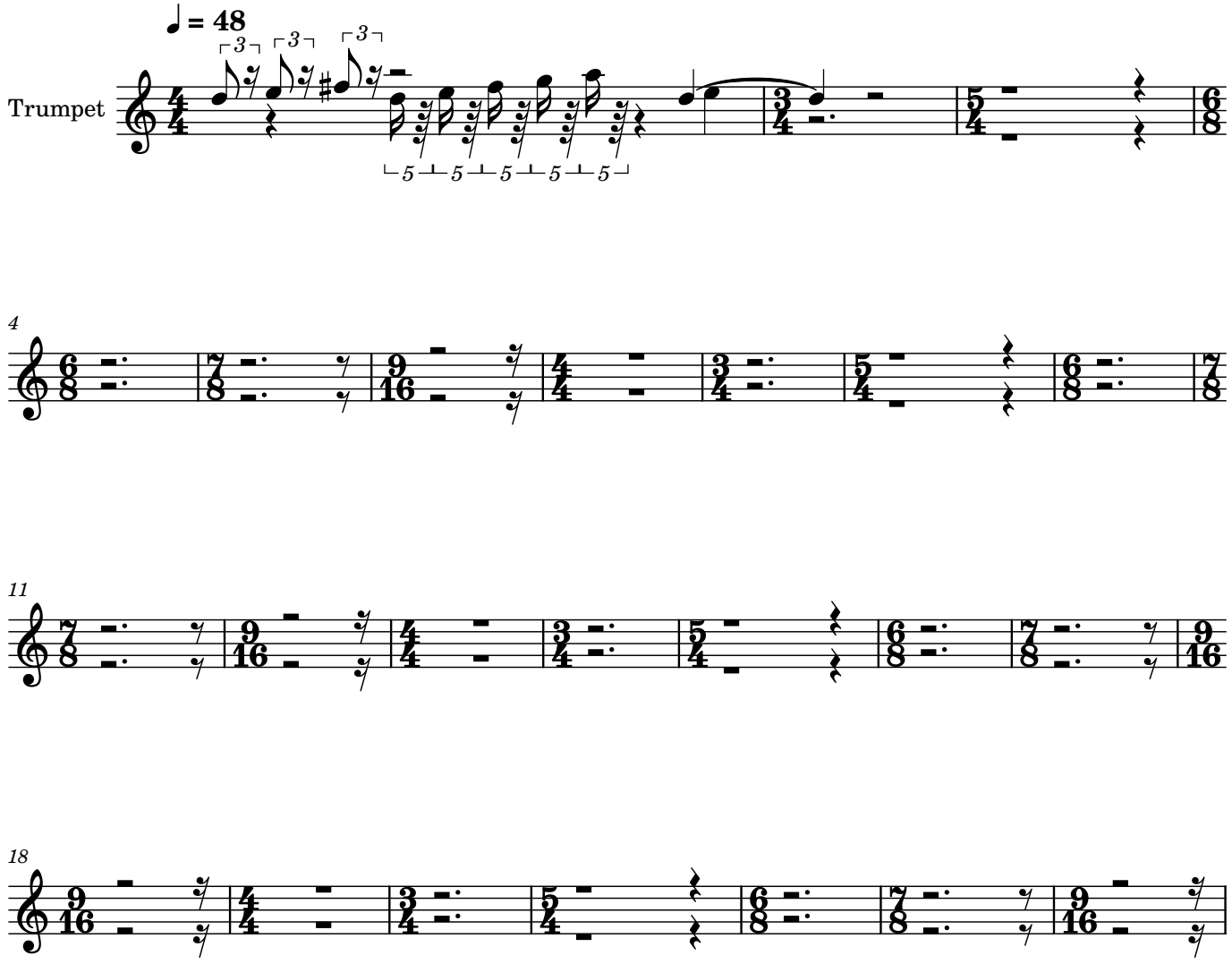E2 stress